ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 49

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Khmer Alphabet

អក្ខរក្រមខ្មែរដំបូងរបស់ខ្ញុំ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 42 Khmer Letters with English Phonetics

ក ខ គ ឃ ង ច

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Khmer Alphabet — អក្ខរក្រមខ្មែរដំបូងរបស់ខ្ញុំ
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 49

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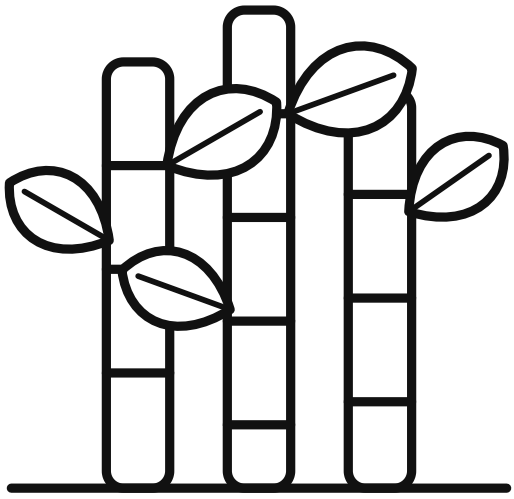
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Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

Fonts: Noto Sans Khmer, Kantumruy Pro, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License. **Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

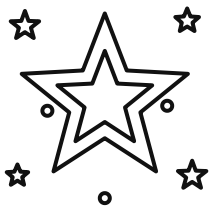


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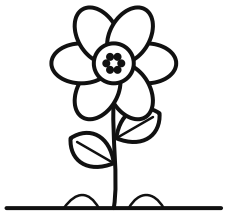
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I started learning Khmer on

_____







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 49 is Khmer. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **Doubled vowels are long:** *aa* as in "father", *ee* as in "see", *oo* as in "moon".
- **a-voice and o-voice:** *ka* has the 'a' of "father"; *ko* has an open 'o', like the 'aw' in "saw".
- **h after a letter** (*kh*, *chh*, *th*, *ph*) means "add a puff of breath". Without the h (*k*, *ch*, *t*, *p*) say it with **no** puff, as in "skip", "stop", "spin". *th* is never the English "th" of "the".
- **ea** is said like "ee-uh" run together: គា *kea* sounds like "kee-uh".
- **eu / ue** is an 'oo' said with flat, smiling lips.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Khmer name** written in Khmer (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Khmer phonetics* shows whether a consonant is an **a-voice** or **o-voice** letter, and how it reads with the vowel sign ◌ា: ក + ◌ា = កា *kaa*, but គ + ◌ា = គា *kea*. For a full vowel it shows the spelling it sounds like.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow the standard Khmer of Phnom Penh.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Khmer! ខ្មែរ

khmae — the Khmer word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **18 million people** speak Khmer.[3] It is the language of **Cambodia**.

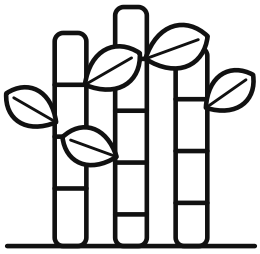
Where?
In **Cambodia**, on the great **Mekong River**, and in nearby parts of Thailand and Vietnam, and by Khmer families around the world.

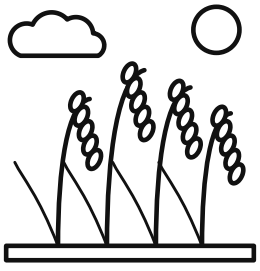
How is it written?
In the **Khmer script**, from **left to right**. Words in a sentence are usually written **without spaces** between them!

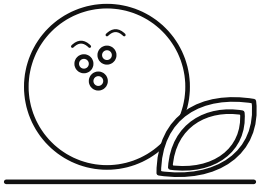
How many letters?
This book teaches **42**: the **33 consonants** and **9 full vowels**. Khmer also has more than twenty small vowel signs.

A very old script
Khmer writing has been carved on stone for more than **1,300 years**. It is one of the oldest scripts of Southeast Asia.

Did you know?
Cambodia's **Tonle Sap** lake grows to several times its size in the rainy season, when the Mekong pushes water back up the river into it!







THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Khmer Alphabet អក្ខរក្រម

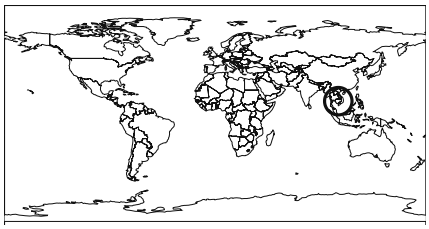
33 consonants — ព្យញ្ជនៈ

ក *ka*	ខ *kha*	គ *ko*	ឃ *kho*	ង *ngo*	ច *cha*	ឆ *chha*
ជ *cho*	ឈ *chho*	ញ *nyo*	ដ *da*	ឋ *tha*	ឌ *do*	ឍ *tho*
ណ *na*	ត *ta*	ថ *tha*	ទ *to*	ធ *tho*	ន *no*	ប *ba*
ផ *pha*	ព *po*	ភ *pho*	ម *mo*	យ *yo*	រ *ro*	ល *lo*
វ *vo*	ស *sa*	ហ *ha*	ឡ *la*	អ *a*		

9 full vowels — ស្រៈពេញ

ត *e*	ឿ *ei*	ឧ *o*	ឺ *euv*	ឫ *ru*	ឬ *rue*	ឭ *lue*	ឯ *ae*	ឱ *ao*

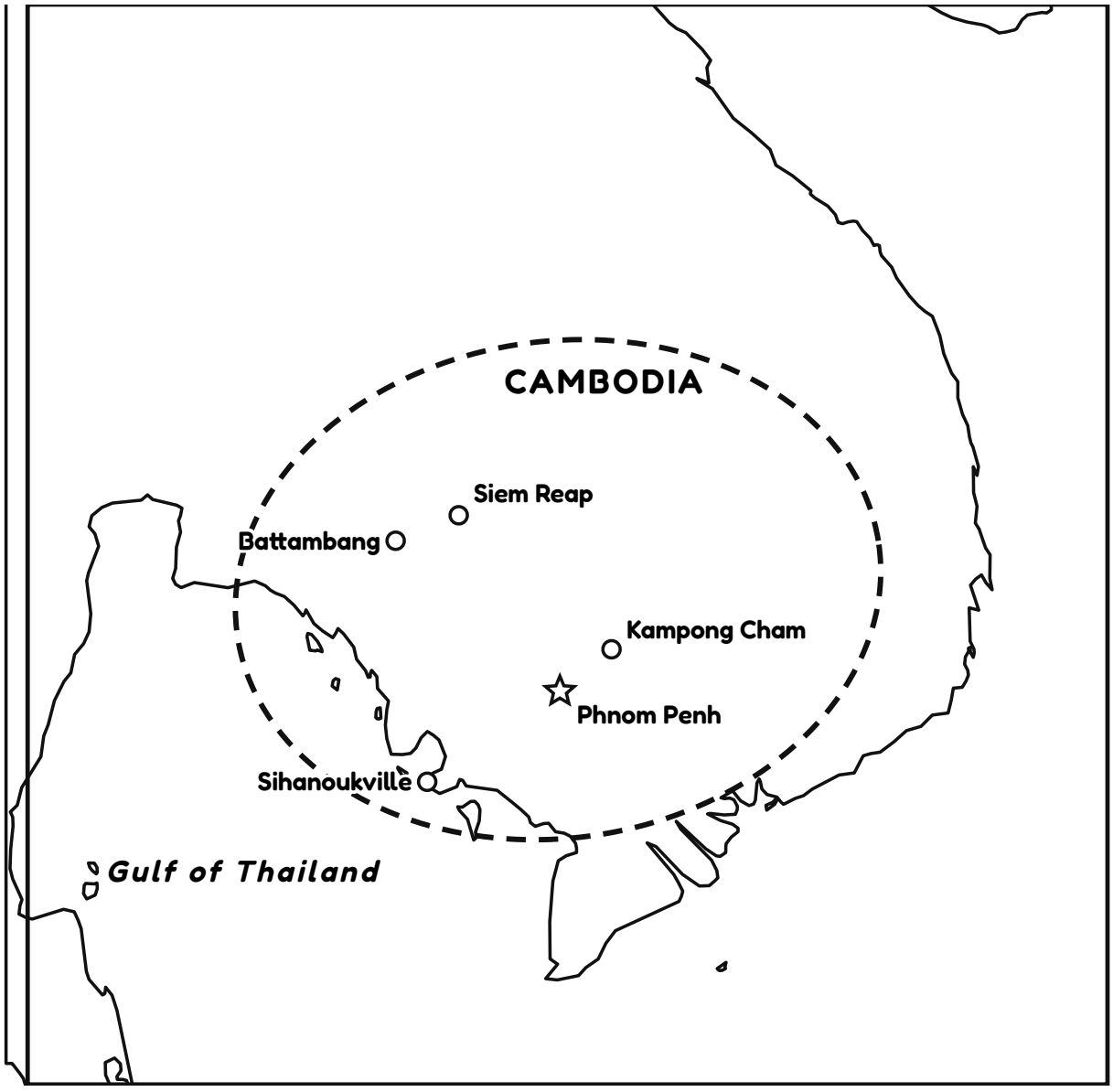
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Cambodia on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Khmer spoken?



Color it: the land where Khmer is spoken (inside the dashed line) **yellow** · the rest of the land **green** · the sea **blue**. **Find it:** Phnom Penh ★ sits where the rivers meet. Draw the big **Mekong River** flowing south to the sea!

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PART 1

The Consonants ព្យញ្ជនៈ

pyun-chea-nak — the 33 consonants

Khmer children first learn the **33 consonants**, in the same order as this book: ក ខ គ ឃ ង *ka, kha, ko, kho, ngo…*

Two voices

Every consonant carries a hidden vowel. Some carry **'a'** (as in "father") — the **a-voice** letters, like ក *ka*. Others carry **'o'** (like "aw" in "saw") — the **o-voice** letters, like គ *ko*. The voice changes how a vowel sign is read:

ក + ◌ា = កា *(kaa)* · គ + ◌ា = គា *(kea)*

Pairs

Many sounds come in pairs, one of each voice: ក/គ ខ/ឃ ច/ជ ឆ/ឈ ដ/ឌ ត/ទ ថ/ធ ប/ព ផ/ភ ស ហ ឡ អ. Listen for the voice!

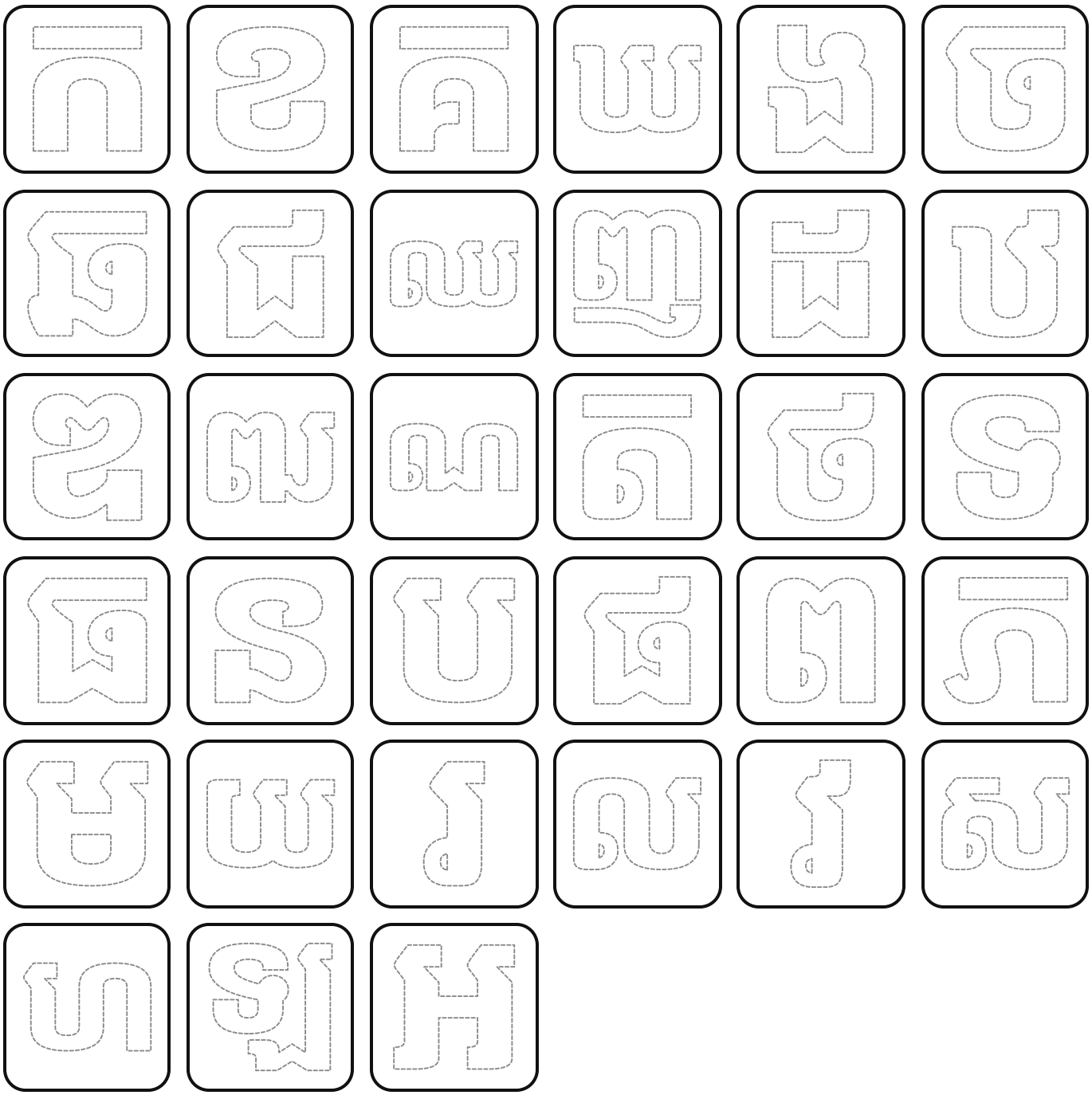
Letters with feet

When two consonants sit together with no vowel between them, the second one shrinks and hangs **under** the first as a little "foot" (ជើង *cheung*): ក + ◌្ = ក្. You will see feet in many words in this book, like ផ្កា *phkaa* (flower).

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the consonants ព្យញ្ជនៈ:

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ក

ka

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “skip” (no puff of air)

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ក + ◌ា = កា *(kaa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘a’ as in “father” · សំឡេង អ



ក IS FOR

កន្ត្រក

kan-trak

basket

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

ក ក ក ក

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ខ

NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ខ

kha

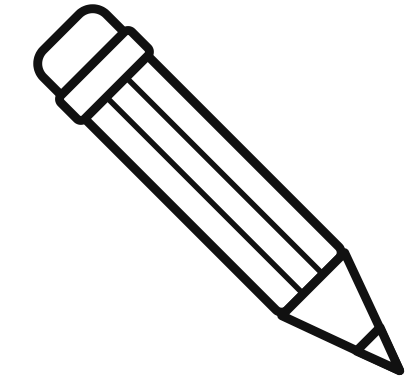
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'k' with a puff of air, as in "kite"

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ខ + ◌ា = ខា *(khaa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'a' as in "father" · សំឡេង អ



ខ IS FOR

ខ្មៅដៃ

khmao-dai

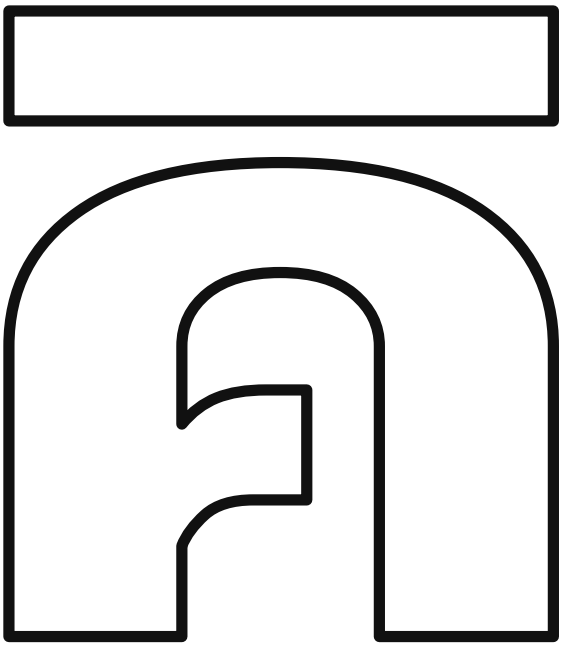
pencil

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

គ

ko

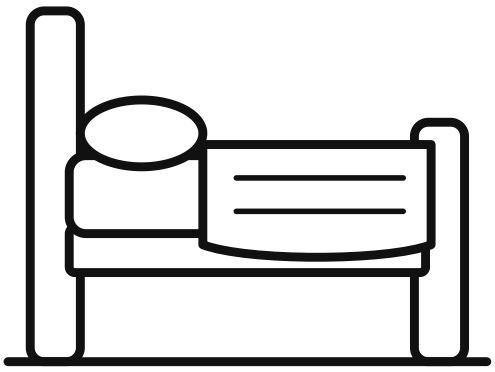
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “skip”, with the o-voice

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

គ + ◌ា = គា *(kea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘o’, like the ‘aw’ in “saw” · សំឡេង អូ



គ IS FOR

ក្រែ

krae

bed

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

គ គ គ គ

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ឃ

NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឃ

kho

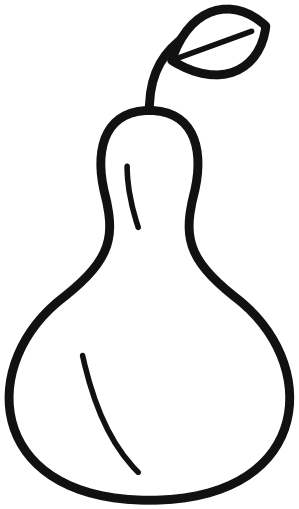
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'k' with a puff of air, with the o-voice

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ឃ + ◌ា = ឃា *(khea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'o', like the 'aw' in "saw" · **សំឡេង អូ**



ឃ IS FOR

ឃ្លោក

khlouk

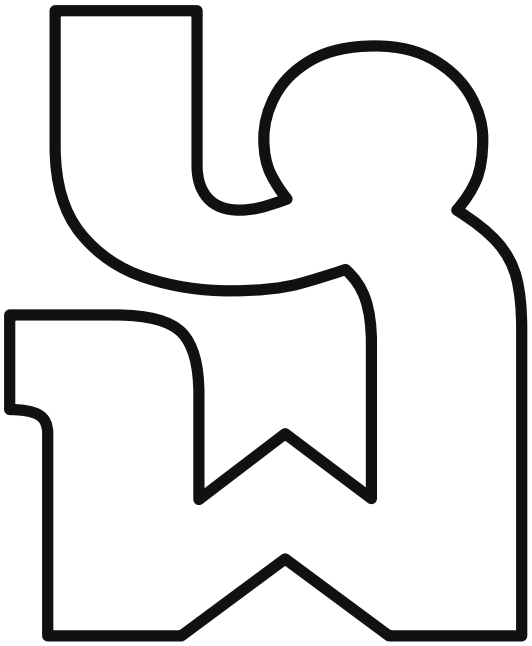
bottle gourd

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ង

ngo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ng' as in "sing" — Khmer words can start with it!

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ង + ◌ា = ងា *(ngea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'o', like the 'aw' in "saw" · **សំឡេង អូ**



ង IS FOR

ងងឹត

ngo-ngut

dark (at night)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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ច

NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ច

cha

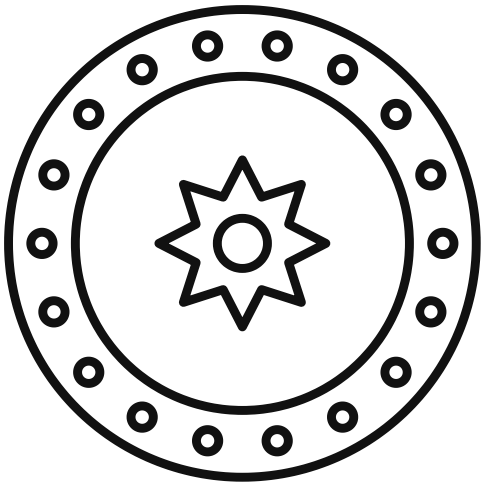
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ch' as in "chair", but softer

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ច + ◌ា = ចា *(chaa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'a' as in "father" · សំឡេង អ



ច IS FOR

ចាន

chaan

plate

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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ឆ

NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឆ

chha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ch' with a puff of air

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ឆ + ◌ា = ឆា *(chhaa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'a' as in "father" · សំឡេង អ



ឆ IS FOR

ឆ័ត្រ

chhat

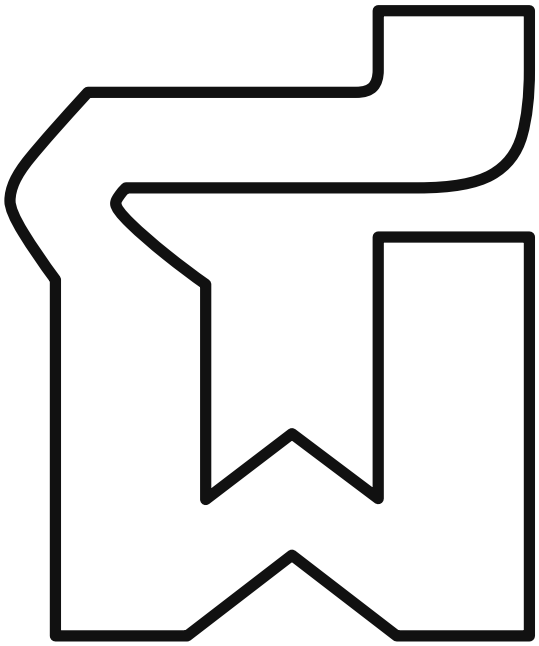
umbrella

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ជ

cho

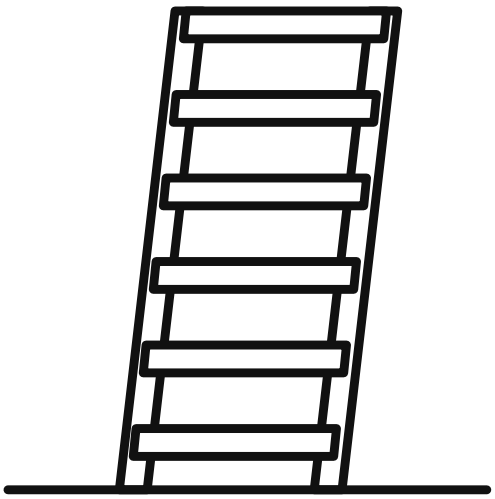
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”, with the o-voice

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ជ + ◌ា = ជា *(chea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘o’, like the ‘aw’ in “saw” · សំឡេង អូ



ជ IS FOR

ជណ្តើរ

chun-daeur

ladder

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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chho

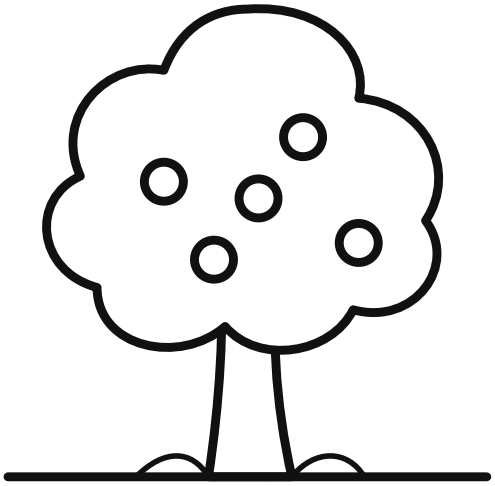
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ with a puff of air, with the o-voice

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ឈ + ◌ា = ឈា *(chhea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘o’, like the ‘aw’ in “saw” · **សំឡេង អូ**



ឈ IS FOR

ឈើ

chheu

wood, trees

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ញ

nyo

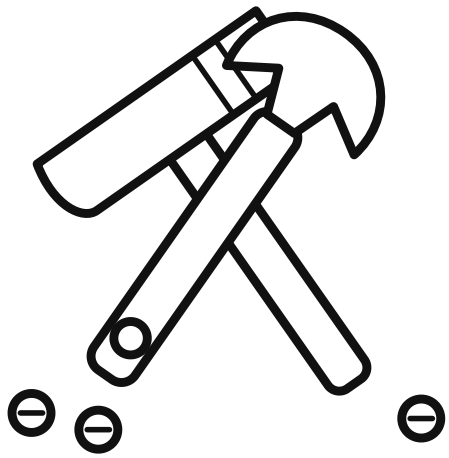
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ny' as in "canyon"

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ញ + ◌ា = ញា *(nyea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'o', like the 'aw' in "saw" · **សំឡេង អូ**



ញ IS FOR

ញ្ញរ

nyo-nyuor

hammer

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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da

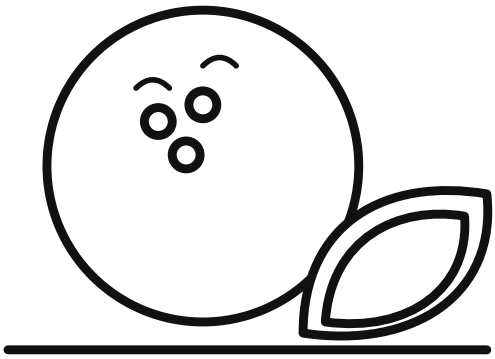
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “day”

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ដ + ◌ា = ដា *(daa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘a’ as in “father” · សំឡេង អ



ដ IS FOR

ដូង

doung

coconut

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឋ

tha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

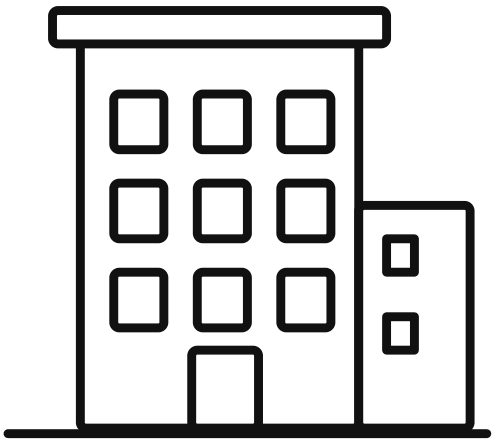
‘t’ with a puff of air — a rare letter

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ឋ + ◌ា = ឋា *(thaa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘a’ as in “father” · សំឡេង អ

ឋ is a rare letter, used in a few words that came from the old Pali and Sanskrit languages. In សណ្ឋាគារ it hides as a little foot under ណ — can you find it?



ឋ IS FOR

សណ្ឋាគារ

son-thaa-kia

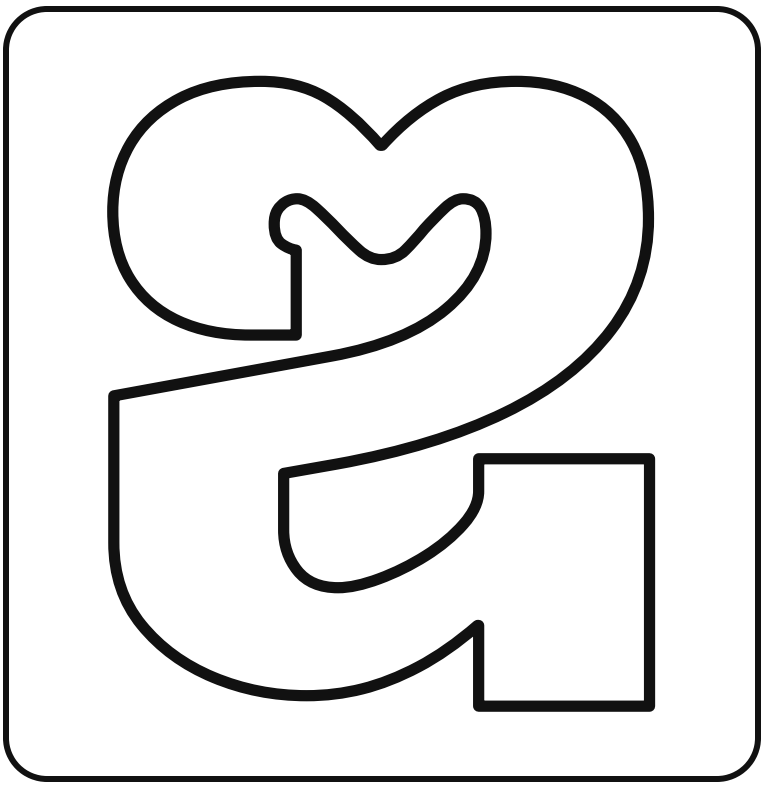
hotel

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឌ

do

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

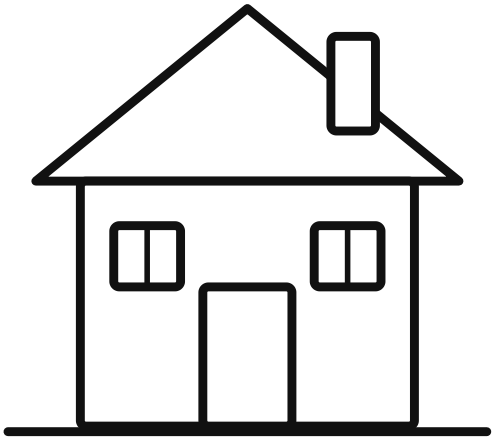
‘d’ as in “day”, with the o-voice — a rare letter

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ឌ + ◌ា = ឌា *(dea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘o’, like the ‘aw’ in “saw” · **សំឡេង អូ**

ឌ is a rare letter, used in a few words that came from the old Pali and Sanskrit languages. In **មណ្ឌល** it hides as a little foot under **ណ** — can you find it?



ឌ IS FOR

មណ្ឌល

mon-dol

centre (a meeting place)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឍ

tho

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

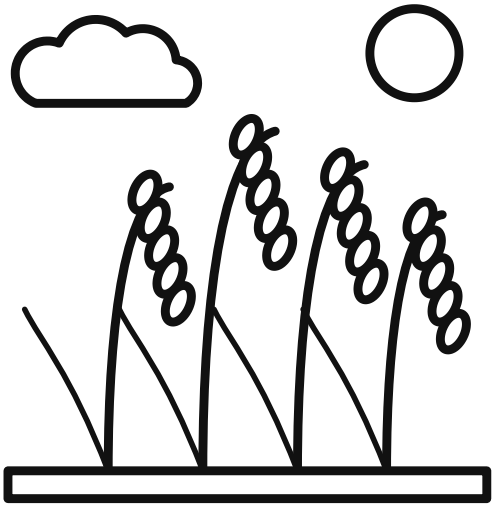
‘t’ with a puff of air, with the o-voice — a rare letter

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ឍ + ◌ា = ឋា *(thea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘o’, like the ‘aw’ in “saw” · **សំឡេង អូ**

ឍ is a rare letter, used in a few words that came from the old Pali and Sanskrit languages. In វឌ្ឍនៈ it hides as a little foot under ឌ — can you find it?



ឍ IS FOR

វឌ្ឍនៈ

vot-tha-nak

growing, getting bigger

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ណ

na

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

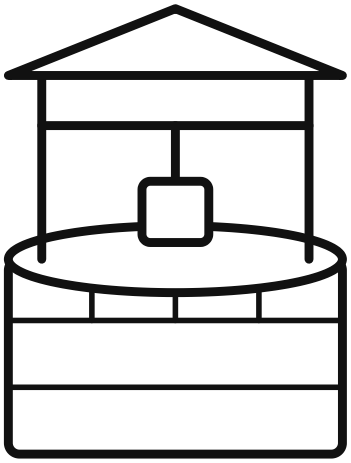
'n' as in "net" — almost never at the start of a word

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ណ + ◌ា = ណា *(naa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'a' as in "father" · សំឡេង អ

Find ណ in the middle of អណ្តូង!



ណ IS FOR

អណ្តូង

an-doung

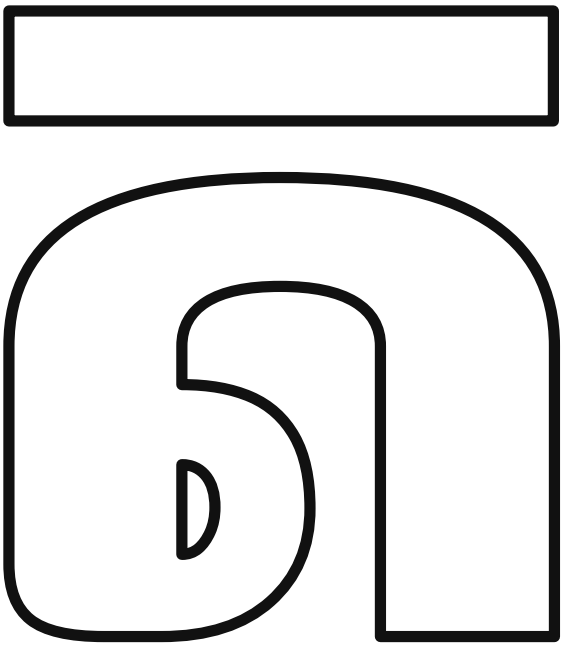
well (for water)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

តា

ta

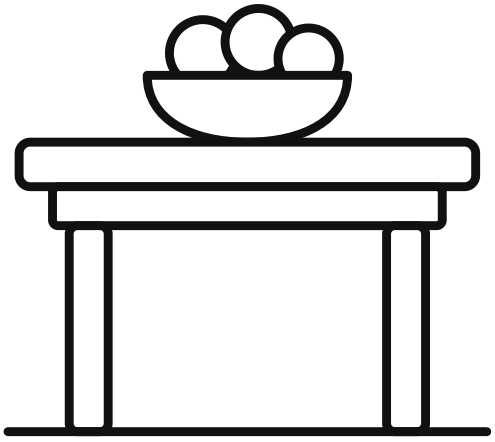
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “stop” (no puff of air)

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ត + ◌ា = តា *(taa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘a’ as in “father” · **សំឡេង អ**



ត IS FOR

តុ

tok

table

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

តា តា តា តា

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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tha

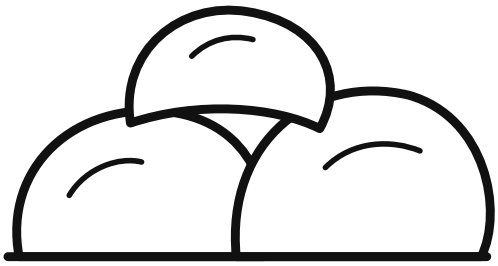
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ with a puff of air, as in “top”

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ថ + ◌ា = ថា *(thaa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘a’ as in “father” · សំឡេង អ



ថ IS FOR

ថ្ម

thmaa

stones

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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to

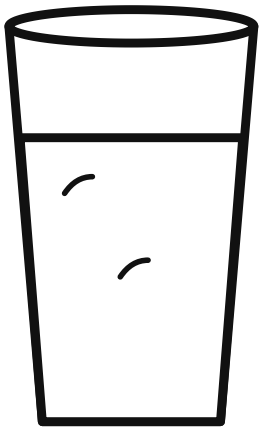
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “stop”, with the o-voice

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ទ + ◌ា = ទា *(tea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘o’, like the ‘aw’ in “saw” · **សំឡេង អូ**



ទ IS FOR

ទឹក

tuk

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · **សរសេរ**

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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tho

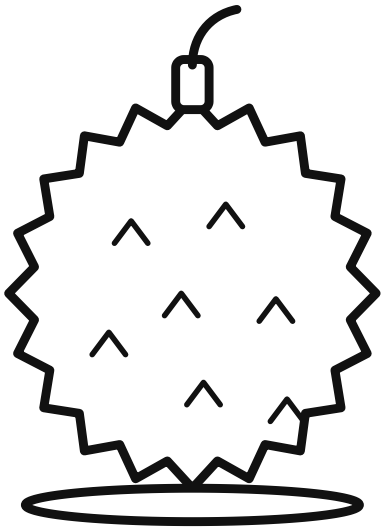
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ with a puff of air, with the o-voice

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ធ + ◌ា = ធា *(thea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘o’, like the ‘aw’ in “saw” · **សំឡេង អូ**



ធ IS FOR

ធុរេន

thu-reen

durian (a spiky fruit)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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no

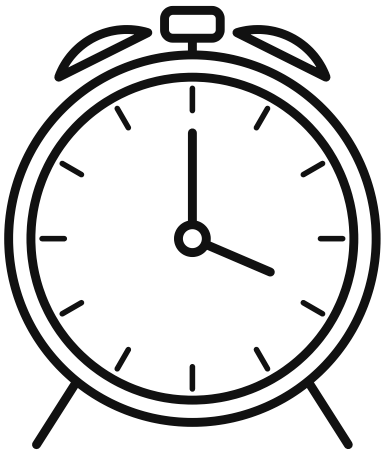
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'n' as in "net"

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ន + ◌ា = នា *(nea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'o', like the 'aw' in "saw" · **សំឡេង អូ**



ន IS FOR

នាឡិកា

nea-li-kaa

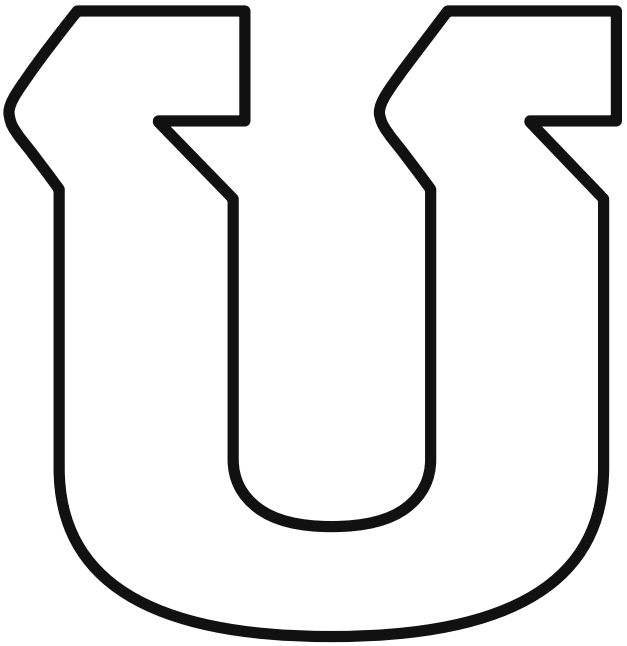
clock

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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ba

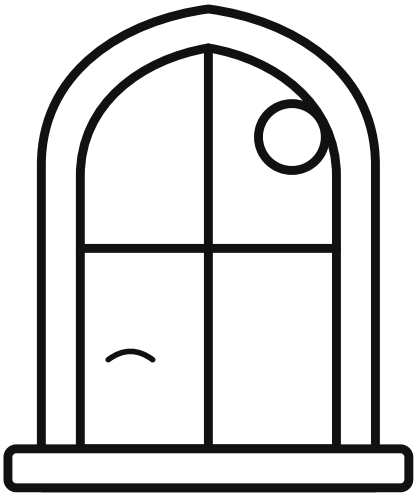
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ប + ◌ា = បា *(baa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘a’ as in “father” · សំឡេង អ



ប IS FOR

បង្អួច

bang-uoch

window

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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pha

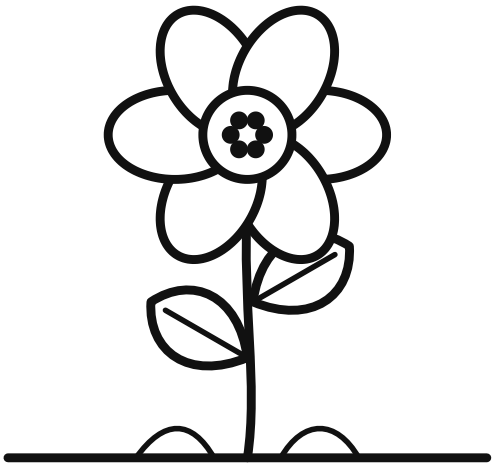
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'p' with a puff of air, as in "pen"

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ផ + ◌ា = ផា *(phaa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'a' as in "father" · សំឡេង អ



ផ IS FOR

ផ្កា

phkaa

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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po

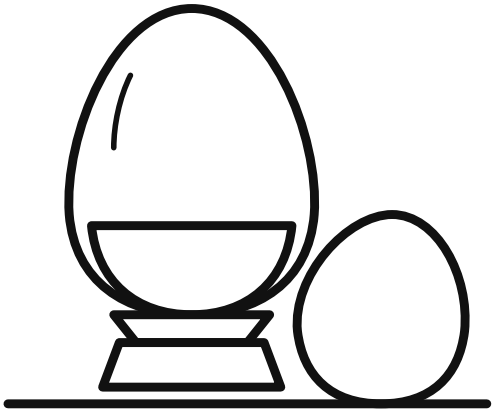
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'p' as in "spin" (no puff of air)

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ព + ◌ា = ពា *(pea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'o', like the 'aw' in "saw" · **សំឡេង អូ**



ព IS FOR

ពង

pong

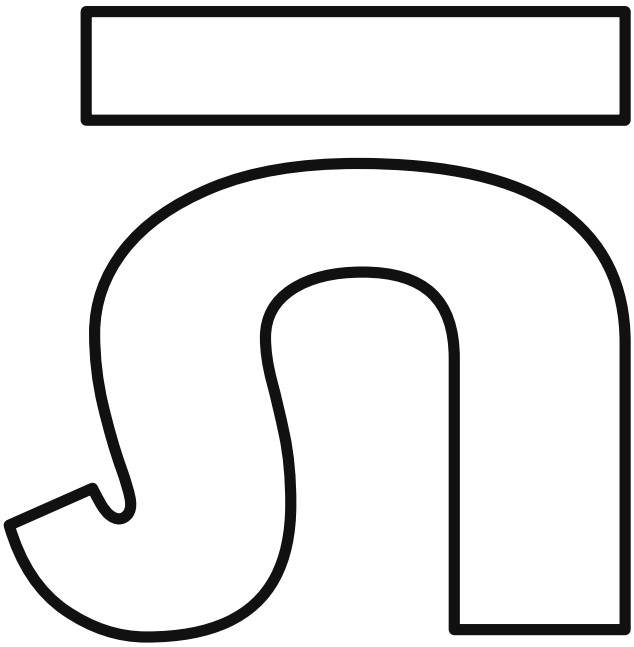
egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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pho

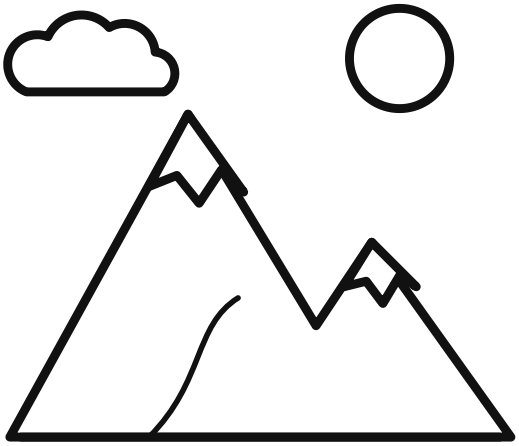
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'p' with a puff of air, with the o-voice

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ភ + ◌ា = ភា *(phea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'o', like the 'aw' in "saw" · **សំឡេង អូ**



ភ IS FOR

ភ្នំ

phnum

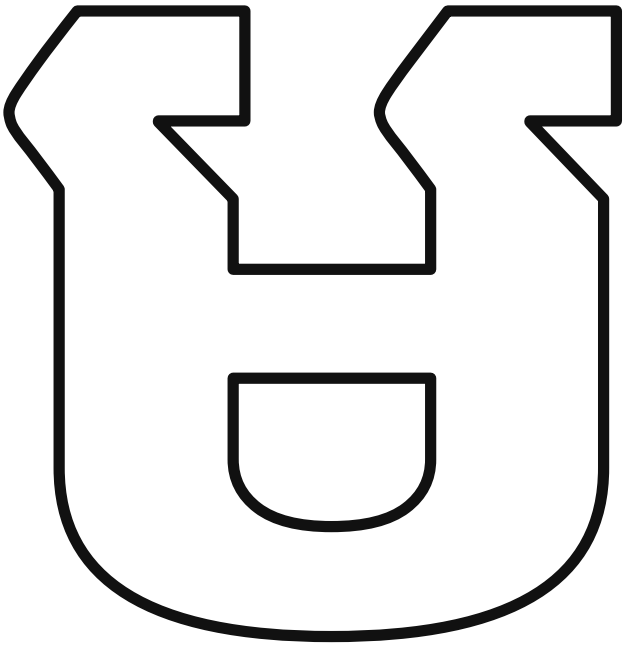
mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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mo

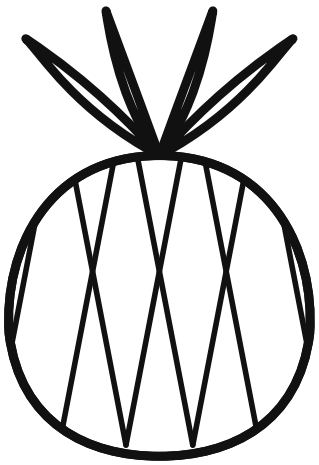
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'm' as in "moon"

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ម + ◌ា = មា *(mea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'o', like the 'aw' in "saw" · សំឡេង អូ



ម IS FOR

ម្នាស់

mnoas

pineapple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

ម ម ម ម

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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yo

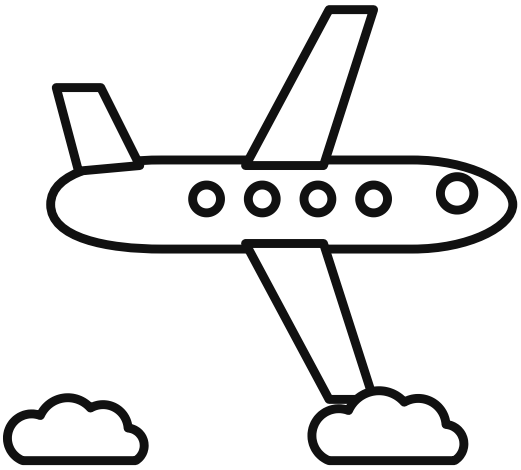
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'y' as in "yes"

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

យ + ◌ា = យា *(yea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'o', like the 'aw' in "saw" · សំឡេង អូ



យ IS FOR

យន្តហោះ

yon-hoh

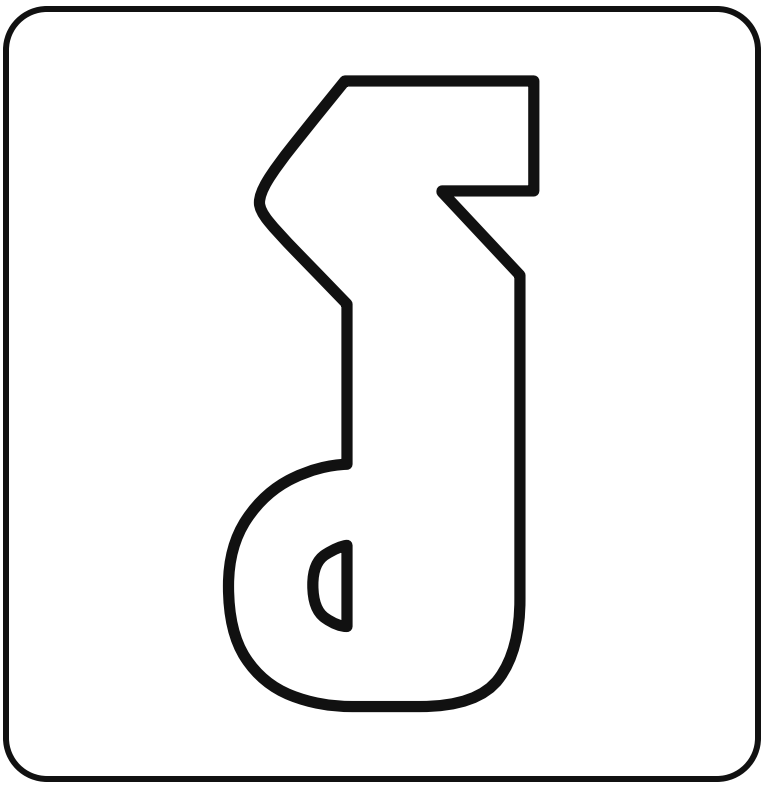
aeroplane

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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ro

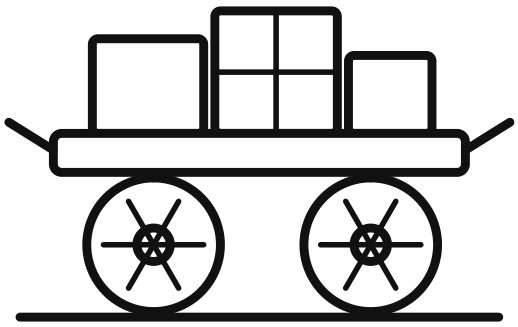
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a light rolled ‘r’

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

រ + ◌ា = រា *(rea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘o’, like the ‘aw’ in “saw” · **សំឡេង អូ**



រ IS FOR

រទេះ

ro-teh

cart

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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lo

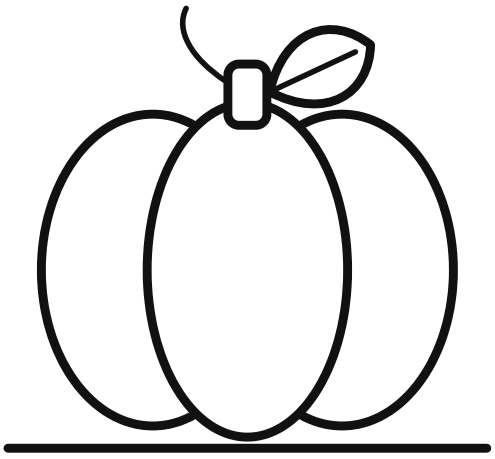
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ល + ◌ា = លា *(lea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'o', like the 'aw' in "saw" · **សំឡេង អូ**



ល IS FOR

ល្ពៅ

l-pov

pumpkin

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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vo

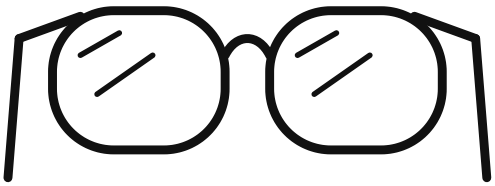
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘v’ or ‘w’ — between the two

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

វ + ◌ា = វ៉ា *(vea)*

an **o-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘o’, like the ‘aw’ in “saw” · **សំឡេង អូ**



វ IS FOR

វ៉ែនតា

vaen-taa

glasses

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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ស

NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ស

sa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ស + ◌ា = សា *(saa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘a’ as in “father” · សំឡេង អ



ស IS FOR

សៀវភៅ

siev-phov

book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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ha

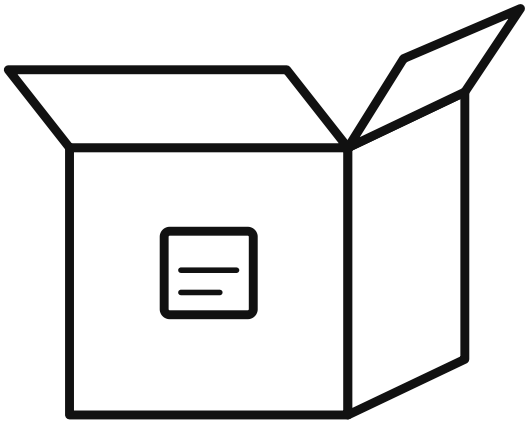
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'h' as in "hat"

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ហ + ◌ា = ហា *(haa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'a' as in "father" · សំឡេង អ



ហ IS FOR

ហិប

hep

chest, box

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឡ

la

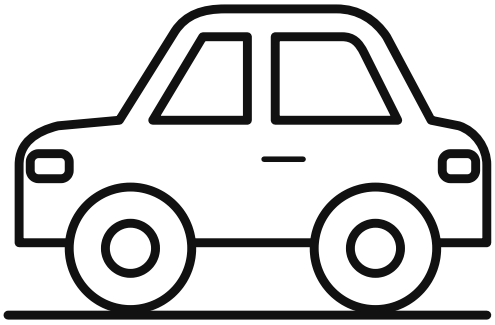
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp", with the a-voice

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

ឡ + ◌ា = ឡា *(laa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is 'a' as in "father" · **សំឡេង អ**



ឡ IS FOR

ឡាន

laan

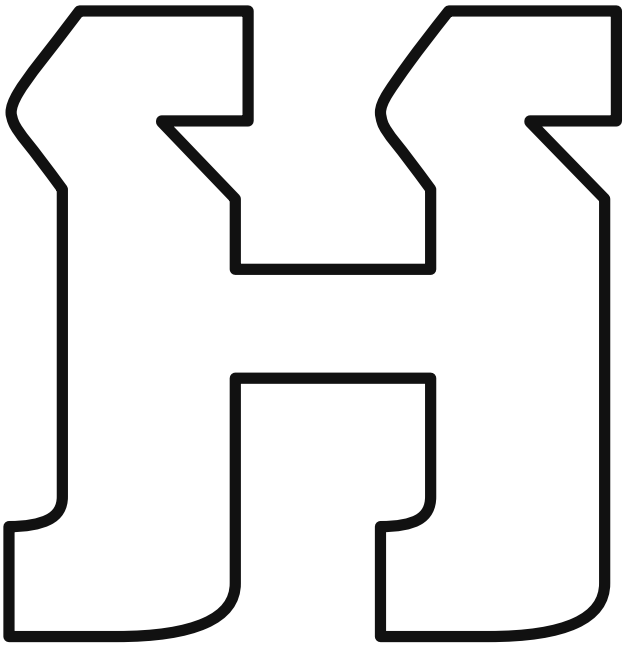
car

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

អ

a

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

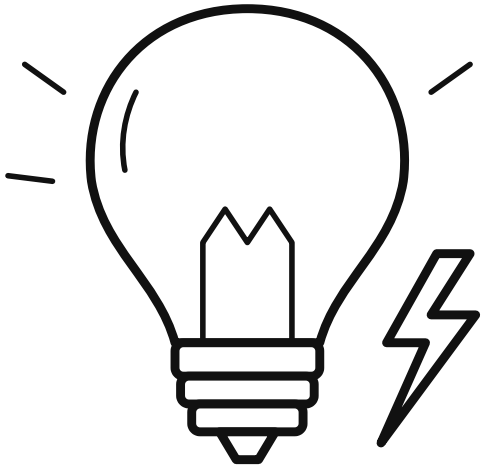
a little catch in the throat, then the vowel — like the start of “uh-oh”

KHMER PHONETICS · VOICE

អ + ◌ា = អា *(aa)*

an **a-voice** letter: its hidden vowel is ‘a’ as in “father” · សំឡេង អ

អ also carries vowel signs at the start of a word: អា អិ អី អុ...



អ IS FOR

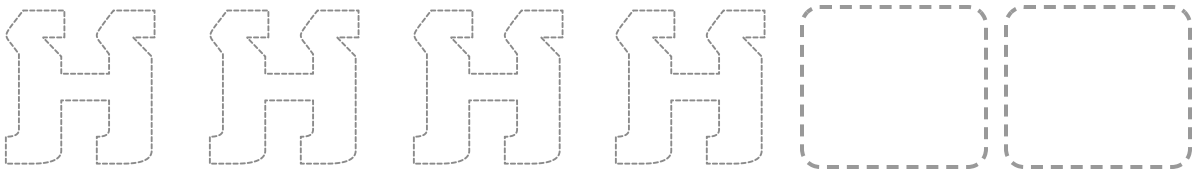
អំពូល

am-pul

light bulb

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ



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PART 2

The Full Vowels ស្រៈពេញ

srak penh — “full vowels”

Most Khmer vowels are small **vowel signs** written around a consonant: above, below, before or after it — កា កិ កី កុ កូ កេ កែ កោ… There are more than twenty of them, and each one sounds a little different with an a-voice or an o-voice consonant.

Full vowels

A few vowels also have a **full letter** of their own, called ស្រៈពេញ *srak penh*. A full vowel stands alone: it never needs a consonant. This book teaches the **9 full vowels** children meet most often: ឥ ឦ ឧ ឪ ឫ ឬ ឭ ឯ ឱ

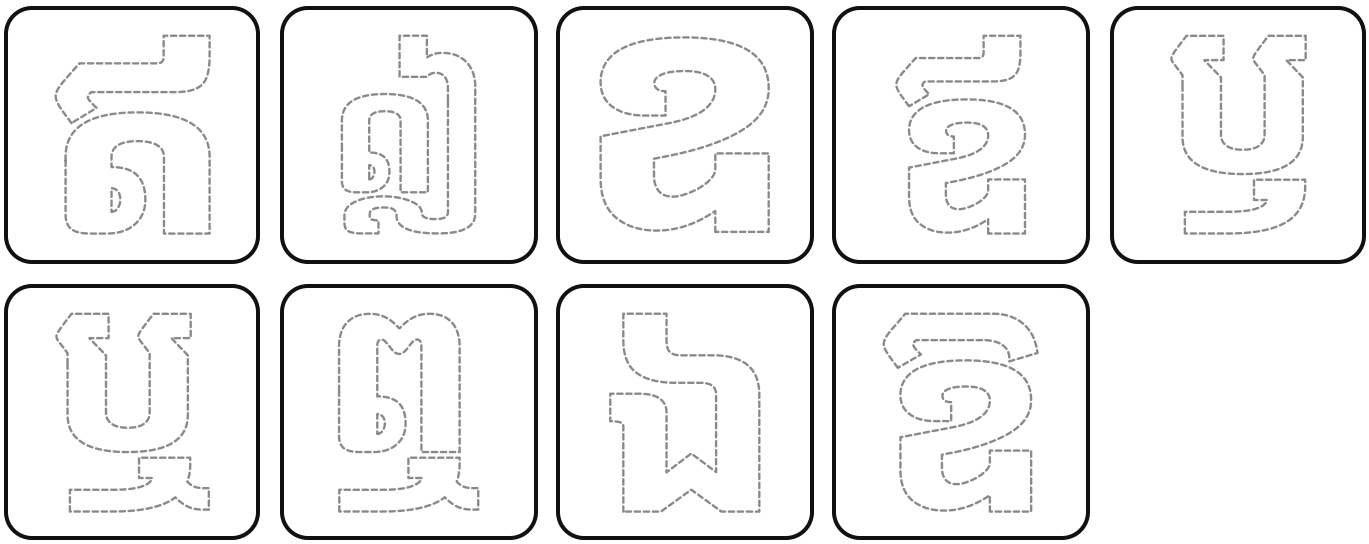
Sounds like…

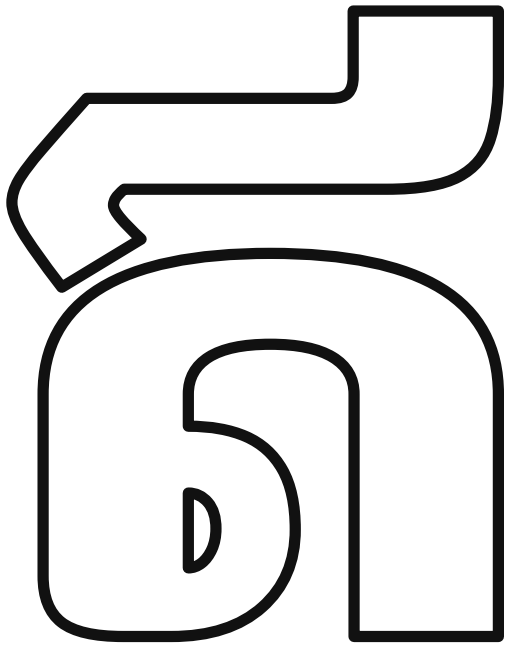
Each full vowel sounds about the same as អ (or រ, ល) with a vowel sign: ឥ ~ អិ, ឯ ~ អែ, ឫ ~ រឹ. A few more full vowels (ឩ ឮ ឰ ឳ) are found only in a handful of old words.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the full vowels ស្រៈពេញ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឥ

e

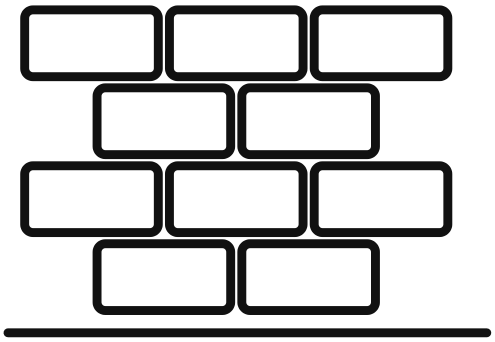
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘e’, like the ‘i’ in “bit”

KHMER PHONETICS · FULL VOWEL

ឥ ~ អិ

A **full vowel**: it stands alone and needs no consonant. It sounds about the same as អិ.



ឥ IS FOR

ឥដ្ឋ

et

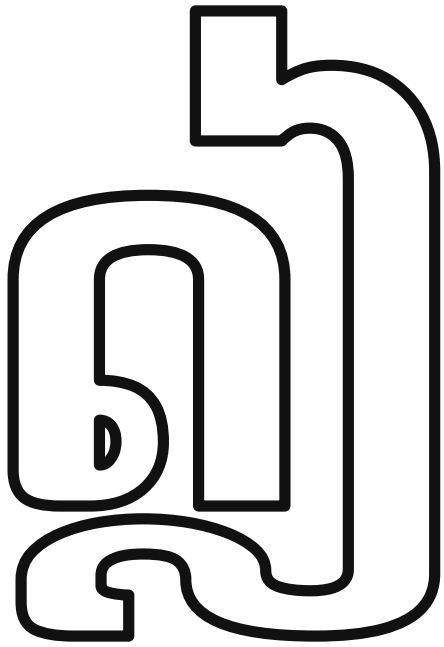
brick

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឡៀ

ei

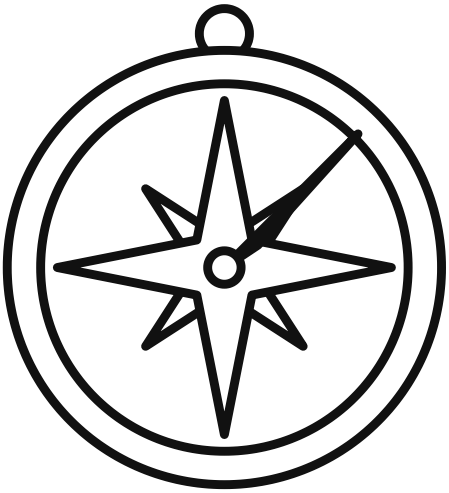
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ei' as in "eight"

KHMER PHONETICS · FULL VOWEL

ឡៀ ~ អ៊ី

A **full vowel**: it stands alone and needs no consonant. It sounds about the same as អ៊ី.



ឡៀ IS FOR

ឡៀសាន

ei-saan

north-east (on a compass)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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ឧ

NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឧ

o

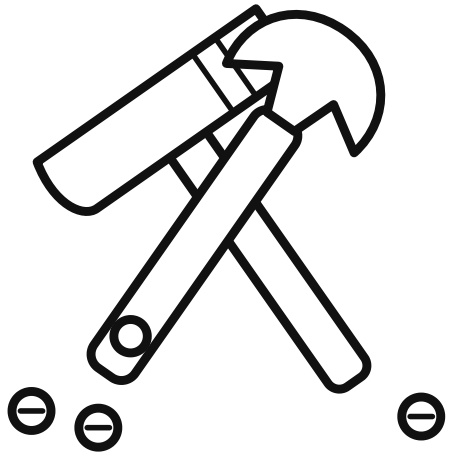
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘o’ as in “book”

KHMER PHONETICS · FULL VOWEL

ឧ ~ អ៊ុ

A **full vowel**: it stands alone and needs no consonant. It sounds about the same as អ៊ុ.



ឧ IS FOR

ឧបករណ៍

u-pa-kaa

tools

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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euv

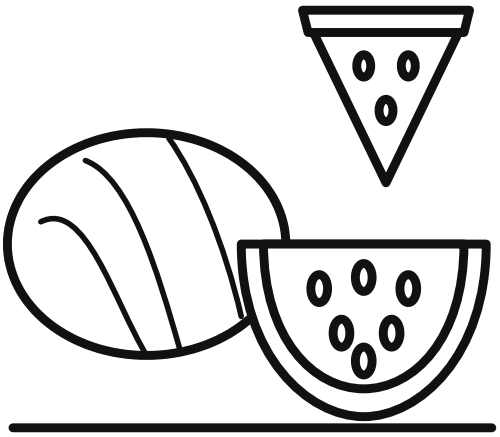
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'euv' — say 'uh' and round your lips into 'oo'

KHMER PHONETICS · FULL VOWEL

ឥ ~ អៀ

A **full vowel**: it stands alone and needs no consonant. It sounds about the same as អៀ.



ឥ IS FOR

ឥទ្ធឹក

euv-luek

watermelon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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ឫ

NAME · ឈ្មោះ

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ru

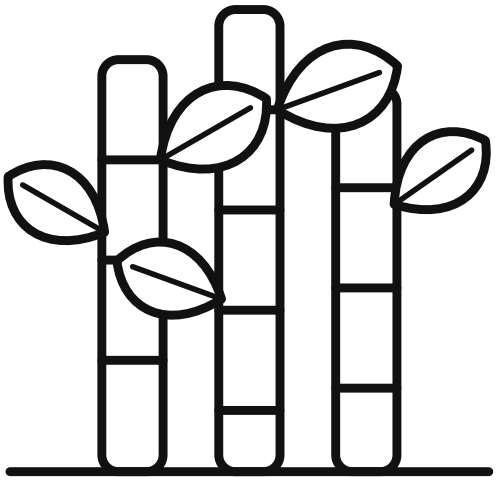
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ru' with a short 'u' said with flat lips

KHMER PHONETICS · FULL VOWEL

ឫ ~ រឹ

A **full vowel**: it stands alone and needs no consonant. It sounds about the same as **រឹ**.



ឫ IS FOR

ឫស្សី

rue-sey

bamboo

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឬ

rue

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

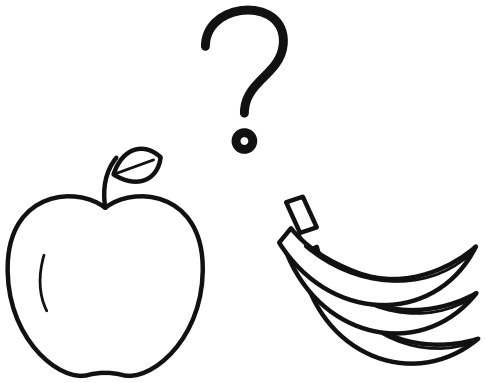
‘rue’ — a long ‘u’ said with flat lips

KHMER PHONETICS · FULL VOWEL

ឬ ~ រឺ

A **full vowel**: it stands alone and needs no consonant. It sounds about the same as **រឺ**.

ឬ is a whole word by itself: it means “or”.



ឬ IS FOR

ផោម ឬ ចេក?

paom rue chek?

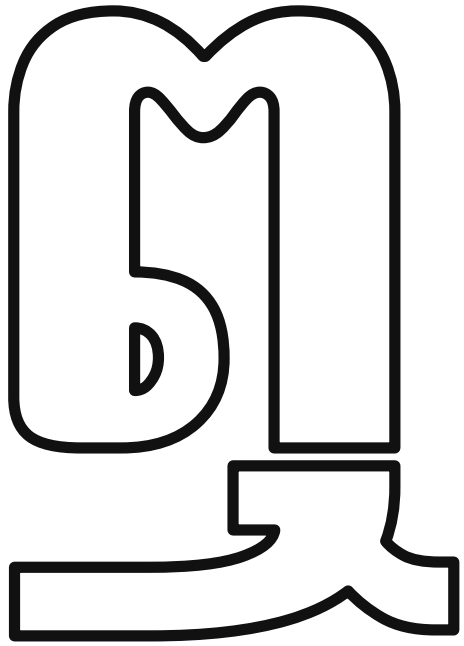
an apple or a banana? (ឬ means “or”)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឮ

lue

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

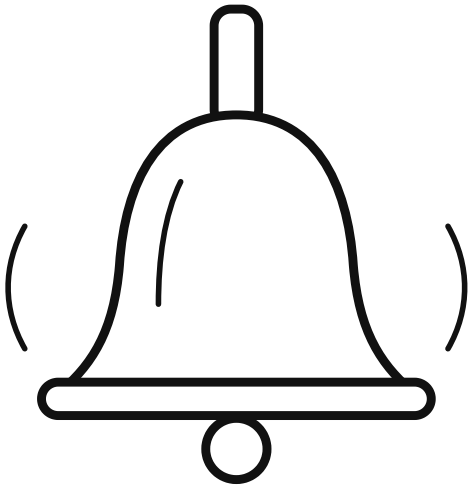
'lue' — a long 'u' said with flat lips

KHMER PHONETICS · FULL VOWEL

ឮ ~ លឺ

A **full vowel**: it stands alone and needs no consonant. It sounds about the same as **លឺ**.

ឮ is a whole word by itself: it means "to hear".



ឮ IS FOR

ឮ

lue

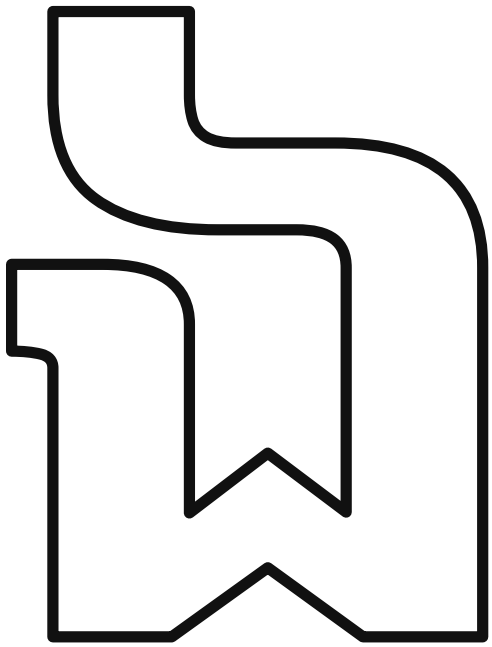
to hear (the bell)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឯ

ae

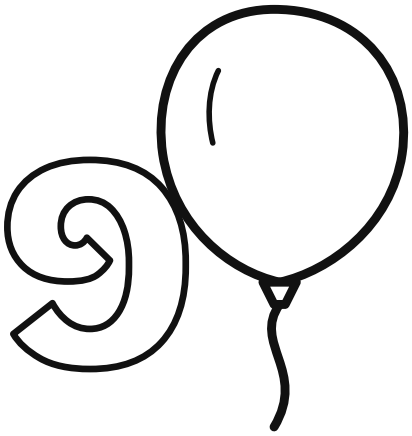
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ae' — like the 'a' in "cat", said long

KHMER PHONETICS · FULL VOWEL

ឯ ~ អែ

A **full vowel**: it stands alone and needs no consonant. It sounds about the same as អែ.



ឯ IS FOR

ឯក

aek

one, alone

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

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ឱ

NAME · ឈ្មោះ

ឱ

ao

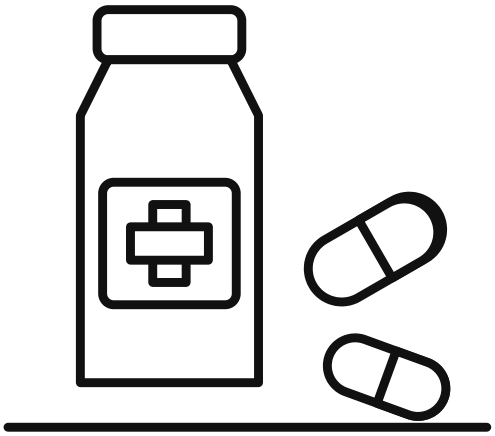
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ao' as in "now", said with rounded lips

KHMER PHONETICS · FULL VOWEL

ឱ ~ អោ

A **full vowel**: it stands alone and needs no consonant. It sounds about the same as អោ.



ឱ IS FOR

ឱសថ

ao-sot

medicine

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · សរសេរ

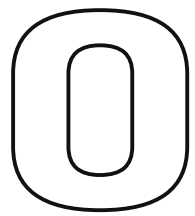
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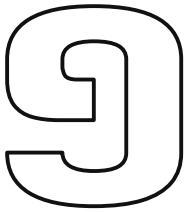
BONUS

Khmer numbers លេខ *(lekh)*

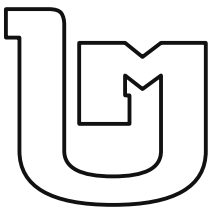
Color the numbers and count out loud in Khmer: *soun*, *muoy*, *pii*, *bei*...



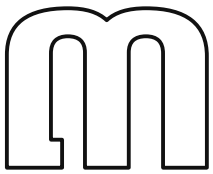
0
សូន្យ
soun
zero



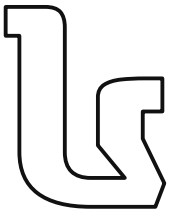
1
មួយ
muoy
one



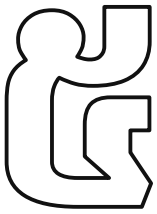
2
ពីរ
pii
two



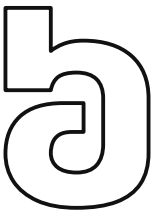
3
បី
bei
three



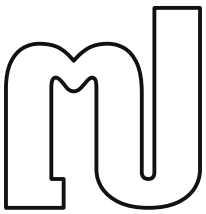
4
បួន
buon
four



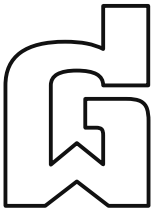
5
ប្រាំ
pram
five



6
ប្រាំមួយ
pram-muoy
six



7
ប្រាំពីរ
pram-pii
seven



8
ប្រាំបី
pram-bei
eight



9
ប្រាំបួន
pram-buon
nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Khmer words ពាក្យដំបូង

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

អាស្សាឡាមូអាឡៃកុំ
as-sa-laa-mu a-lai-kum
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

វ៉ាអាឡៃកុំអាស្សាឡាម
wa a-lai-kum as-sa-laam
And upon you be peace (the reply)

ខ្ញុំឈ្មោះ ...
khnyom chhmuoh ...
My name is ...

អរគុណ
aw-kun
Thank you

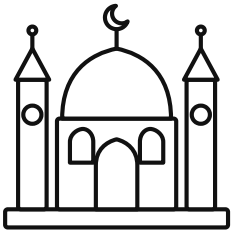
ជ៉ាហ្សាកាល់ឡោះហ៊ូខៃរ៉ន
ja-zaa-kal-laa-hu khai-ran
May Allah reward you with good

ម្តាយ · ឪពុក
m-daay · euv-puk
Mother · Father

បងប្រុស · បងស្រី
bong pros · bong srey
Brother · Sister (older)

បាទ / ចាស · ទេ
baat / chaas · te
Yes (a boy / a girl says) · No

ខ្ញុំកំពុងរៀនភាសាខ្មែរ!
khnyom kom-pung rien phea-saa khmae!
I am learning Khmer!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

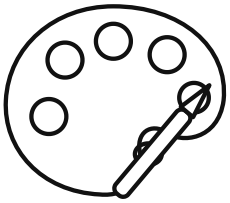
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **42 Khmer letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Khmer, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ម៉ាស្ហាអល់ឡោះ! ពូកែណាស់!

maa-shaa-al-loh! puu-kae nah! — Mashallah! Well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 42 letters of the Khmer alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

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